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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 4 | The Other Feelings in Relationship

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. AFFECTION (sneh) is the feeling of acceptance of the other as one's own — the feeling that arises when trust and respect are established. CARE (mamta) is the feeling of responsibility toward the BODY of the other — nurturing and protecting it (feeding, sheltering, nursing). GUIDANCE (vatsalya) is the feeling of responsibility toward the SELF of the other — ensuring right understanding and right feeling in them. Care without guidance produces only bodily comfort; guidance without care becomes preaching; both together fulfil the other as co-existence of Self and Body.
2. Q2. EXCELLENCE (kushalta) is to understand the harmony and live in it — continuously improving ONESELF, where the benchmark is my own yesterday. COMPETITION is trying to get AHEAD OF OTHERS — the benchmark is someone else. Excellence is absolute and inspires others; competition is relative and breeds jealousy, stress and conflict. Education should develop excellence (competence with right understanding), not competition — because in excellence everyone can win together, while in competition one's gain is another's loss.
3. Q3. REVERENCE (shraddha) is the acceptance of excellence in the other — the feeling toward one who has attained right understanding. GLORY (gaurav) is the feeling for one who has made EFFORT for excellence (even if not yet attained). GRATITUDE (kritagyata) is the feeling of acceptance for those who have played a role in MY excellence — parents, teachers, mentors. Reverence looks up to attainment, glory honours striving, gratitude acknowledges contribution to my own growth.
4. Q4. LOVE (prem) is the feeling of being related to ALL human beings — it is the COMPLETE value because it is trust extended to the whole of humanity: 'the feeling of being related to all, in exclusion of none.' INFATUATION is a temporary, sensation- and preconditioning-based attraction toward a particular body — it is conditional, possessive and fades or reverses. Love is stable, universal and liberating; infatuation is unstable, exclusive and binding. Love begins where the feeling of relationship does not stop at family or friends.
5. Q5. JUSTICE (nyaya) is: recognition of human-human relationship, fulfilment of the right feelings in that relationship, leading to MUTUAL HAPPINESS. Its five elements: (1) RECOGNITION of relationship, (2) the right VALUES/feelings, (3) right EVALUATION, (4) MUTUAL FULFILMENT, and (5) its expression in behaviour. Justice is not merely legal punishment — it begins in the Self with the nine feelings and ends in mutual happiness. Where feelings are right, behaviour is just naturally; laws are only a backstop.
6. Q6. Reflecting on gratitude: I recognise my parents (who nurtured me unconditionally), my school teachers (who shaped my thinking) and a friend who stood by me in failure as contributors to my excellence. Earlier I took these as given; now I feel a definite acceptance of their role, and it naturally expresses itself as respect, care and the wish to do the same for others. Gratitude, I find, is not a debt to be repaid but a feeling that multiplies relationship.